

AI governance enters the *global gender* framework.

For the first time, the world's largest forum on women's rights has embedded AI governance language — while deepfake accountability advances case by case, and women disappear from the tech roles that will shape AI's future.

6

MUST-KNOW SIGNALS

16–20 MAR

COVERAGE WINDOW

3

EMERGING SIGNALS

W12 2026

CALENDAR WEEK

TL;DR

- Women face nearly 2× the generative AI workplace risk — ILO: 29% of female-dominated vs. 16% of male-dominated occupations exposed globally.
- CSW70 embeds AI governance in a global gender equality framework for the first time — passed 37–1–6, US sole dissent.
- AI deepfake accountability advances: Washington State passes SB 5105; Kansas City women sue under the DEFIANCE Act.
- Digital violence in Arab States escalating: 49% of women online feel unsafe; 44% report abuse moving into physical spaces.
- AI labels young women "fragile" in 56% of responses and steers 75% toward social or care careers (LLYC study, 12 countries).

MUST KNOW

01

CSW70 Embeds AI Governance in the Global Gender Equality Framework

GLOBAL · POLICY

The UN Commission on the Status of Women (CSW) concluded its 70th session with Agreed Conclusions that, for the first time, include explicit language on AI governance, digital justice, and women's rights in digital spaces. The vote was 37–1–6, with the United States casting the sole dissent — opposing language on AI governance, reproductive health, and gender identity. UN Secretary-General Guterres warned of "male chauvinism filling the gap" when women are absent from digital systems design.

Why it matters: The largest global forum on women's rights now includes AI governance language — a normative baseline that did not exist before March 2026, which civil society can use as leverage in national and regional policy processes.

POLICY

GENDER

02

AI Deepfake Accountability Advances on Two Legal Fronts

USA · GENDERED RISKS

Washington State passed SB 5105, targeting AI-generated sexually explicit depictions of minors. Separately, three anonymous women from Kansas City filed a federal lawsuit against the AI pornography industry for generating non-consensual explicit deepfakes from public social media photos, testing the scope of the DEFIANCE Act. AI image synthesis tools can scrape publicly

available photos and produce explicit synthetic content at industrial scale, with victims predominantly women aged 18–30. Enforcement against offshore providers remains the critical unsolved challenge.

Why it matters: Legal accountability for AI-generated abuse is being built case by case — but the gap between legal precedent and actual enforcement remains wide.

RISK

GENDER

POLICY

03

Digital Violence in Arab States: Nearly Half of Women Online Feel Unsafe

MENA · GENDERED RISKS

A UN Women Arab States study covering 22 countries finds 49% of women internet users do not feel safe from online harassment. 70% of women activists and human rights defenders received unwanted sexual images; 62% received insulting or hateful messages. 44% of women who experienced online violence reported the abuse escalating into physical spaces. 1 in 5 deleted or deactivated their social media accounts entirely. 35% reported feeling sad or depressed; 12% had suicidal thoughts.

Why it matters: Digital safety is a prerequisite for digital economic participation — and in Arab States, the safety barrier is keeping women offline at the moment the digital economy is accelerating.

RISK

GENDER

04

AI Skills Gap Narrowing Globally — But a Reverse Gap Is Emerging at the Frontier

GLOBAL · LABOR MARKET

World Economic Forum (WEF)/LinkedIn data shows the gender gap in AI skills has narrowed in 74 of 75 economies since 2018, with the global gap now 68.8% closed. Female enrolment in generative AI courses on Coursera rose from 32% to 36% (2023–2025). However, in the US and UK, men's enrolment growth is now outpacing women's. Randstad data shows only 27% of US women (vs. 34% of men) have been offered AI upskilling by their employer — training budgets continue to flow disproportionately to already-male tech teams.

Why it matters: Closing the skills gap is necessary but not sufficient for parity — structural barriers in hiring and training access can negate enrolment gains entirely.

WORK

05

AI Models Label Young Women "Fragile" and Steer Them Away from Technical Careers

GLOBAL · CULTURAL

A 12-country study by LLYC (March 2026) finds AI language models are 2.5× more likely to use "artificial empathy" with young women than young men. In 56% of responses, AI systems labelled young women as "fragile." Models recommended external validation to young women six times more often than to young men, and steered 75% toward social or care-oriented careers. Large language models trained on historical data replicate and amplify existing gender stereotypes, acting as informal career advisors at a formative stage of identity development.

Why it matters: AI is becoming an informal career advisor for millions of young people — and it is already giving young women systematically more limiting guidance than young men.

CULTURAL

RISK

06

Arab States: Women Face 3× the Automation Risk of Men — and a Missed Augmentation Opportunity

MENA · LABOR MARKET

An ILO report on the Arab labour market finds that 5.3% of female-held jobs in Arab States are at full automation risk, compared to 1.6% of male-held jobs — a ratio of more than 3:1. Women in the region are heavily clustered in public-sector clerical and

administrative roles, precisely the occupational category most exposed to generative AI task substitution. At the same time, the ILO identifies a significant augmentation opportunity: 22.7% of women's jobs in Arab States could benefit from AI-assisted productivity gains — but only if reskilling investment and employer adoption follow.

Why it matters: The MENA region faces a sharper gender asymmetry in AI risk than the global average — and the window to convert automation pressure into augmentation gains is narrow.

WATCHPOINT

Whether Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) governments include gender-disaggregated AI reskilling targets in their national AI strategies, currently under revision in Saudi Arabia and the UAE.

WORK

RISK

EMERGING SIGNALS

- 01

Women disappearing from European tech as AI reshapes the sector

McKinsey finds women hold just 19% of core tech roles in Europe — down from 22% in 2023. Only 8% of executive tech roles are held by women. AI-related roles are seeing men capture a larger share of entry-level positions, compressing the pipeline further.
- 02

AI-enabled gendered disinformation in politics

A European Parliament Research Service brief warns that AI-enabled gendered disinformation — synthetic audio, manipulated video, coordinated smear campaigns — is being deployed to chill women's democratic participation. Women politicians and activists are the primary targets.
- 03

Women fear professional backlash from AI at work (US)

CNBC/SurveyMonkey survey finds 64% of US women report never using AI at work (vs. 55% of men). The fear of being seen as less capable — or more capable — when using AI tools is creating a self-silencing dynamic.

DATA GAPS & UNKNOWNNS

!

No government currently tracks AI-linked layoffs by gender. All displacement estimates are modelled from occupational task analysis, not measured job loss data.

!

The 900% deepfake growth figure (pi-labs) lacks a clear baseline year and methodology disclosure. Treat as directional evidence of rapid growth, not a precise measurement.

!

WEF/LinkedIn skills data systematically undercounts women in non-profiled or informal roles, particularly in low- and middle-income countries and MENA.

!

Intersectionality largely unmeasured: most reports do not disaggregate by age, ethnicity, disability, or socioeconomic status alongside gender.

CSW70 GLOBAL — UN Press Release WOM/2249, 9 March 2026 (press.un.org) — UN Women CSW70 Agreed Conclusions (unwomen.org)	Digital Violence in Arab States MENA — UN Women Arab States — 'Digital Violence in the Arab States', November 2025 (arabstates.unwomen.org)
Deepfake Accountability USA — Transparency Coalition / Washington State Legislature — SB 5105, 20 March 2026 — Axios / KCTV5 — Deepfake lawsuit, Kansas City, 18 March 2026	AI Skills Gap GLOBAL — WEF / LinkedIn — AI Gender Parity, March 2026 (weforum.org) — Coursera — Gender Gap in GenAI Report 2026 (blog.coursera.org) — Diginomica / Randstad, March 2026

AI Gender Bias in Career Guidance GLOBAL

— LLYC / Yahoo Finance — 'Illusion of Equality: The Impact of AI on Young People's Thinking', March 2026

ILO Arab Labour Markets MENA

— ILO — 'Navigating the Digital and AI Revolution in Arab Labour Markets', September 2025 (ilo.org)

Women in European Tech EUROPE

— McKinsey — 'Women in Tech and AI in Europe', March 2026 (mckinsey.com)

Gendered Disinformation EU

— EPRS — 'Women in the Age of AI-Enabled Disinformation', BRI(2026)782670 (europarl.europa.eu)